dependent on the military to stay in power, abandoning his plans to improve relations with both Afghanistan and India.

Far from recognizing the APS attacks as a failure of the state and the military in protecting innocent civilians, another narrative evolved – the victims were described as martyrs who had sacrificed their lives for their country. Accounts of heroism of teachers and fellow students inundated media coverage of the tragedy, with the role of the army further strengthened in the fight against cowards who attack children. Government schools had put up posters of the 'martyrs', while children performed school plays re-enacting the tragedy, and recognizing the sacrifices of the students and teachers. Another intervention that was connected to the APS tragedy was introducing narratives of resilience and tolerance in schools through supplementary reading material and textbooks. Resilience was believed to be needed in order to re-establish the support of the Pakistani people in its military and security personnel, but to link intolerance with the APS attacks was clearly misleading. In discussing the APS tragedy with participants in this study, there was no clear narrative that emerged. Some very clearly held the TTP responsible as shown in the following quotes:

> *Q.: What about the Peshawar attack. A.: Obviously it was the Taliban. They took responsibility.*
>
> *Q.: Why did they do it? A.: As revenge against the army. They clearly gave their reasons.*
>
> (Focus Group, Private University[17])

But there were others who were hesitant in admitting that the TTP were behind these attacks. '*TTP not responsible. We don't know – if only we knew*' (Focus Group, Government University[18]).

In one government university in Lahore students blamed RAW and the United States rather than the TTP, claiming that there were forces behind the TTP who may have directed the attack: '*Let's call the attackers terrorists; Isn't that enough, calling them terrorist, why do we need to identify them?*' (Focus Group, Government University[19]). Others believed that the responsibility lay with the federal and provincial governments who had failed to protect the students and their teachers. However, there were other opinions such as '*I think the Peshawar attacks completely changed the thinking of the nation. It was a huge event that has completely changed politics in Pakistan. Raheel Sharif has emerged as a hero*' (Focus Group, Private University[20]). The student was right, there seemed to be a commitment from the government, and the army, that the long-time policy of distinguishing good versus bad Taliban had been abandoned. However, this